MOREH NEVUCHIM

Born Adam, Become Ish: The Rambam on Jacob's Ladder & the Ascent of Man

Given Tuesday 21 July 2026 · Moreh Nevuchim I:14-15

Sefer: Moreh Nevuchim (Rambam), Chelek Aleph — Rabbi Chaim Makbili's Hebrew edition / Sefaria

Chapters: I:14 — the concept of **Adam** (אדם); I:15 — the term **nitzav** (נצב)

Topic: The three meanings of *Adam*; the mussar of rising from *Adam* to *Ish*; *nitzav* as firm standing vs. permanence; the true meaning of Yaakov's ladder; ונצבת על הצור

Schedule note: This was the **final Moreh shiur of the term** — break until **Elul**, b'ezrat Hashem. The class was announced as Chapters 14, 15 and 16, but **Chapter 16 (*tzur* — צור) was not reached** and will open next term (Chapter 17 then begins a new theme). The Rabbi closed with a passionate plea: **do chazarah of Chapters 1–15 over the summer** — using the note summaries, the transcripts, the recordings, or simply re-reading the Moreh — so that next term we can go straight in.

Recap — Where We Are in the Moreh

Chapter	Term / Theme
1–2	*Tzelem Elokim* — the image of God
3	*Tavnit* and *temunah*
4	*Ra'ah*, *habit*, *chazah* — verbs of seeing
5	Caution in approaching HaKadosh Baruch Hu
6	*Ish ve'ishah* — man and woman
7	*Yalad*
8	*Makom* — place = **rank, status**
9	*Kisei*
10	*Alah ve'yarad* — ascent/descent, including of the **mind**
11	*Yashav* — to sit → **permanence and continuity**; why Hashem "sits in heaven" (the heavens are permanent); the mabul
12	*Kam* — four meanings: physically rising; establishing/fulfilling; rising up against; Hashem executing judgment
13	*Amidah* — three meanings: physical standing; stopping; **permanence**. With Hashem it is always the third meaning — e.g. ואתה פה עמד עמדי, Moshe's constant prophetic experience

Chapters 11–13 (last week) were all "standing" words. Chapter 15 (*nitzav*) continues that thread — but first, in Chapter 14, the Rambam **digresses** to discuss the word *Adam*. Why he digresses is itself the key to the chapter (see below).

Do not confuse Chapter 14 with Chapter 6. Chapter 6 dealt with *ish ve'ishah* (man and woman) in the creation narrative. Here we return to the creation narrative again — but now to discuss what **Adam** means, which is something different.

Chapter 14 — Adam (אדם)

A very short chapter — but as we've seen repeatedly, **the shortest chapters are often the deepest**.

The Three Meanings of Adam

רב משמעויות אדם — the word *Adam* has several meanings.

Meaning 1 — The primordial human

Adam is the **name of the first human**, and it is a **derived name** (שם גזור) — derived from **adamah** (אדמה), the ground, as the pesukim state explicitly:

וייצר ה' אלהים את האדם עפר מן האדמה ויפח באפיו נשמת חיים

Hashem formed the human — **dust from the ground** — and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life.

The Torah says explicitly that he was taken from the ground — hence the name **Adam from adamah**.

Incidental aside (Rav Kook): Chava, the primordial female, was *not* taken from the ground — she was taken **from Adam**. Rav Kook explains that this is why women are generally less earthly and material than men: men are taken directly from the ground, whereas women are taken a level beyond — from the man who is from the ground. Generalizing, this is why women are typically more repulsed by very "earthly" things (blood, a creature in the bathroom) than men are. There is much to discuss here; the Rabbi noted it only in passing.

Meaning 2 — The human race

Adam is also the name of the **human species** as a whole — **והוא שם המין האנושי**:

לא ידון רוחי באדם לעלם בשגם הוא בשר

"My spirit will not abide in the human forever, for he too is flesh" — because humans are composed of material matter, they must have a limited timespan (the 120 years is the general maximum span, even though some individuals lived longer).

מי יודע רוח בני האדם העלה היא למעלה ורוח הבהמה הירדת היא למטה לארץ

(Kohelet) "Who knows the spirit of humans — whether it rises upward, or whether, like the animal's, it descends down to the earth." We discussed this verse at length with Rav Se'adyah Gaon: one reading is that no one knows whether a given human will rise or go down like an animal.

ומותר האדם מן הבהמה אין

(Kohelet; said daily in Shacharit) "The advantage of the human over the animal is naught" — (different texts read אין or a slight advantage).

All three verses clearly use *Adam* for the human **race**, not a specific individual.

The deeper observation — "Ha-Adam" throughout Bereishit

On a deeper level, perhaps some — or even all — of the mentions of *Adam* in the creation narrative refer not to a specific individual but to the human species. **Once you notice this, you can't un-notice it:**

Go through Parashat Bereishit and count how many times it says **אדם** without the definite article. **Only twice.** Everywhere else it is **הָאָדָם** — *the* human:

ויגרש את **האדם** · הן **האדם** היה כאחד ממנו · ויקרא **האדם** שם אשתו חוה

The first time the Torah calls him simply "Adam" as a name is only in **chapter 4, verse 25**:

וידע אדם עוד את אשתו ותלד בן ותקרא את שמו שת

— when the primordial human has relations with his wife and fathers another human being. Until then, through nearly four chapters, he is always *ha-Adam*. This opens the discussion of whether the "Adam" of the opening chapters is one human — or the human species. The Rambam does say plainly (meaning 1) that Adam is the primordial human's name, but the

Torah's consistent *ha-Adam* shows something deeper is going on. Most people who read Bereishit have never picked this up — and it changes the whole reading of the parashah.

Jack's observation: all of the Rambam's proof-texts for the *second* meaning (the human race) themselves carry the definite article — *ba-adam*, *bnei ha-adam*, *ha-adam*. The Rabbi: "Very good, excellent point" — it confirms exactly the pattern above.

Meaning 3 — The masses, in contradistinction to the *ish*

והוא שם להמון — *Adam* is a name for the **multitudes** — כלומר לפשוטי העם, as distinct from the special individuals among them. As it says in **להוציאם מהיחידים שבהם**, Tehillim 49:

שמעו זאת כל העמים... גם בני אדם גם בני איש יחד עשיר ואביון

If *Adam* and *ish* meant the same thing, why repeat? Because they are **two different things**: *ish* means a distinctive, important person; *Adam* means the general masses. Compare Rashi at the start of Parashat Shelach — שלח לך **אנשים**:

כל אנשים שבמקרא לשון חשיבות — *anashim* in Tanach denotes importance.

So the pasuk is saying: rich or poor, whether you are an *Adam* — a simple person — or an *ish* — a distinguished person — everyone pay attention to this psalm.

The Two Verses Explained by Meaning 3

ובמשמעות השלישית הזאת — with this third meaning, the Rambam explains two verses that have agitated commentators.

1. בני האלהים ובנות האדם (end of Parashat Bereishit)

ויראו בני האלהים את בנות האדם כי טבת הנה ויקחו להם נשים מכל אשר בחרו

What — angels marrying humans?! The Rambam — like many Rishonim (Onkelos, one interpretation in Rashi, Ramban) — understands that **בני האלהים has nothing to do with God**. *Elohim* in Tanach can mean a judge or any **important person**. So: the **noblemen** saw the **daughters of the Adam** — the simple girls of the masses — that they were good, ויקחו להם נשים מכל אשר בחרו, and **took advantage of them**, taking women from wherever they chose. Nobility exploiting the common girls — the third meaning of *Adam* exactly.

Rabbi Makbili adds a beautiful alternative reading: the *bnei ha-Elohim* — those created *b'tzelem Elokim*, with great potential — "saw the *bnot ha-adam*": they saw the material world, they saw *adamah*, and **pursued adamah**. Either way, it turns on the Adam/ish distinction.

2. אכן כאדם תמותון (Tehillim 82)

אני אמרתי אלהים אתם ובני עליון כלכם. אכן כאדם תמותון וכאחד השרים תפלו

"I thought (says Asaf) that you were *Elohim*" — important people (proven from the parallel ובני עליון, exalted ones) — "**but in fact you will die like an Adam**" — like a simple person. I thought you were important; in reality you are only simple people.

Related aside: in that same psalm (Tehillim 49 — which by old Sephardi minhag is said in the **beit avel**, and you'll see why):

ואדם ביקר בל ילין נמשל כבהמות נדמו

The *Adam* is compared to an animal — again the Adam/ish distinction: the psalm addresses everyone, גם בני אדם גם בני איש, but the one who remains an *Adam* ends up like an animal.

The Mussar of the Chapter — Rise from Adam to Ish

This short chapter is one of the Moreh's **mussar chapters**. The Moreh is not only about stripping corporeality from our conception of God; it also teaches how to live. The Rambam is telling us: **our duty is to rise to *ish* and not to remain our entire lives as *Adam***.

Look at the verses he chose:

ומותר האדם מן הבהמה אין — if you remain an *Adam*, you are essentially an animal.

ואדם ביקר בל ילין נמשל כבהמות נדמו — and stay rooted in earth, in materialism and physicality — you are compared to the beasts.

אכן כאדם תמותון — you will die *as an Adam*, and all that is left of you is an Adam.

Only the Adam dies. A person who rises from *Adam* — from materialism — becomes an *ish*, becomes *bnei Elohim*, and essentially **does not die**: only the body, the earthly material nature, dies. The *ish* — the intellect, the neshamah — continues forever. **That is what Olam Ha-Ba is: the continuation of the *ish*.** Our *adamah* dies; we continue living as *ishim*.

The Mishnah in Pirkei Avot — a new layer

ובמקום שאין אנשים, השתדל להיות איש

"In a place where there is no *ish* — strive to be an *ish*." There are always *Adam* — wherever you go there is *Adam*. Where there is no *ish*, **you** must become the *ish*: set the example, rise from being *adamah*.

The opening of the Moreh itself

Right at the beginning of the Moreh — immediately after the opening letter to his student — the Rambam quoted three verses, the first of which we now understand far more deeply:

אליכם אישים אקרא וקולי אל בני אדם

"To you, *ishim*, I call; my voice is to the *bnei adam*."

Everyone will read this book — all *bnei Adam* will see it — but the *Adam* will understand it as an *Adam* understands. **The Rambam is calling to the *ishim***. To read this book properly, we have to be an *ish*.

Why Does the Rambam Digress Here?

Chapters 12–13 dealt with *kimah* and *amidah*; Chapter 15 deals with *nitzav* — all "standing" words. Why plant *Adam* in the middle?

Answer 1 (Shem Tov, among the commentaries): Chapter 13 ended with Moshe — ואתה פה עמד עמדי, Moshe's constant prophetic standing with Hashem. Having discussed Moshe's constant nevuah, the Rambam turns to Adam and *ish* — because **Moshe is the quintessential *ish***, the paradigm of one who rose up from being an *Adam*.

Answer 2 (Rav Makbili) — the Rabbi's preferred reading: based on the pasuk in Yechezkel:

ויאמר אלי בן אדם עמד על רגליך ואדבר אתך

"Ben Adam — **stand on your feet** and I will speak with you."

Now the sequence flows beautifully: Chapter 13 — *amidah*, permanence; Chapter 14 — **permanently get up from being an *Adam***. Stand on your feet; rise from *Adam* and go up to *ish*. The Rabbi: "I really think that's the true interpretation of what's going on here."

Chapter 14 — Summary

The word *Adam* has three meanings: (1) the primordial human, named from *adamah*; (2) humanity as a whole — and note the Torah's consistent *ha-Adam* through Bereishit; (3) ordinary people, the masses, in contrast to the elevated *ish*. The Rambam uses this distinction to teach that while every person begins as an *Adam* bound to the material world, **the goal of human life is to become an *ish*** through intellectual and spiritual perfection. Only the *Adam* dies — אכן כאדם תמותון; the *ish*, the intellect, the soul, continues forever. That is Olam Ha-Ba.

Chapter 15 — Nitzav (נצב)

Having discussed *Adam*, the Rambam returns to verbs — and *nitzav* follows beautifully from Chapters 12 (*kimah*, arising) and 13 (*amidah*, standing): another form of standing.

Rav Makbili adds a further connection: it flows from the verse at the beginning of Iyov — a Tisha B'Av reading:

ויהי היום ויבאו בני האלהים להתיצב על ה' ויבוא גם השטן בתוכם

— the *bnei ha-Elohim* (which we just discussed in Chapter 14!) came **להתיצב** before Hashem (see below on what that standing means).

A Grammar Point First

Nitzav or *yitzav* — sometimes the root appears with a **nun** (נצב), sometimes with a **yud** (יצב):

אף שאלו שני שרשים שונים עם שמות במלה אחת... כידוע לך בכל נטיותיהם

Even though these are **two different roots**, they mean the same thing in all their forms. Interesting — the Rabbi noted he had always assumed it was one verb whose nun or yud drops, but the Rambam clearly treats them as two distinct three-letter roots with identical meaning.

Meaning 1 — Standing Firm, Erect, Strong

לעתים משמעותו עמידה והתייצבות — — sometimes it means standing. But not ordinary standing — we've already had *kimah* and *amidah*. This is an **erect, firm, assertive** standing. Three verses:

ותתצב אחתו מרחק לדעה מה יעשה לו

Moshe has been placed in the basket among the reeds; his sister — Miriam, about six years old — stands from afar. *Vatetatzav* here means **peering** — standing craned, looking over intently to know what would happen to him.

יתיצבו מלכי ארץ ורוזנים נוסדו יחד על ה' ועל משיחו

(Opening of Tehillim 2) The kings of the earth **stand against** Hashem — they stand firmly, erect, arrogantly. *Yityatzev* is always a very strong standing.

ודתן ואבירם יצאו נצבים פתח אהליהם ונשיהם ובניהם וטפם

The classic case (which Rashi picks up): in the Korach episode, Moshe goes to make peace, and Datan and Aviram come out **nitzavim** — strong, firm, defiant, at the entrance of their tents.

Aside — why a gravestone is a *matzeivah*: this is why the monument we place is called a מצבה (and Yaakov built a *matzeivah*) — not a *ma'amadah*. Because *nitzav* means to stand **tall, erect and firm**.

And the Iyov verse: ויבאו בני האלהים **להתיצב** על ה' — they came to stand firmly *against* Hashem, to question Him (they proceed to question Him about Iyov). Meaning 1 exactly: standing strong and firm against something.

Meaning 2 — Permanence and Stability

just as *amidah* can mean permanence, so can *nitzav*. The — **ולעתים משמעותו קבעות ותמידות**
:example — a verse said many times on Rosh Hashanah and Yom Kippur

לעולם ה' דברך נצב בשמים

"Forever, Hashem, Your word is *nitzav* in the heavens" — כלומר קבוע וקיים, **fixed and enduring**.

Revision question (from last week): why does the verse locate the permanence of Hashem's word *in the heavens*? Because — as we learned in Chapter 11 — Aristotle and the Rambam viewed the **heavens as permanent**: the celestial bodies endure, unlike everything on earth, which is subject to generation, corruption and death. Your words are stable and unshakeable **like the heavens are stable and unshakeable**.

Aside — the Rashash's 12 recitations: the custom of saying this verse 12 times when taking out the Sifrei Torah on Yom Kippur (and, as far as the Rabbi recalls, Rosh Hashanah) comes from the Rashash — Rabbi Shalom Sharabi, the mekubal of ~250 years ago. His kavanah is entirely different from the Rambam's peshat: *davar* (as opposed to *amar*) denotes **hard** speech — the harsh edicts — so we pray 12 times: may Your hard edicts stay *nitzav* **in heaven** and not descend to us (with 12 different kavanot). Note: Spanish & Portuguese do not say this verse this way at all (perhaps once before the shofar).

With God, it is always Meaning 2

whenever *nitzav* is said of God, it means: **כל אימת שהמונח הזה נאמר על הבורא — הוא במשמעות הזאת**
.**permanence** — never physical erect standing

Yaakov's Ladder — the Rambam's Re-reading

The verse that underscores this:

ויחלם והנה סלם מצב ארצה וראשו מגיע השמימה והנה מלאכי אלהים עלים וירדים בו. והנה ה' נצב עליו

Hashem was "standing" on the ladder? Hashem has no body to stand with. — **והנה ה' נצב עליו**
:Rather **קבוע וקיים עליו** — He is *permanently, constantly* over it.

The context: Yaakov is on the run — fleeing Esav, on his way to Lavan, afraid. Hashem tells him: **I am at the top. Everything is in My control. I am permanent and constant, watching over all of existence.**

The deeper meaning: the ladder stands with one end on the ground and its top reaching heaven, ובו מטפס ועולה כל העולה — all who ascend climb it, rung by rung, until they reach what is at its top. And Hashem is **on top of the ladder but not part of it** — so too in the nimshal: **He is**

above all of existence but not part of existence. Whoever climbs the ladder correctly will encounter the Divine — He is always there. (Rabbi Avraham ben HaRambam discusses this "encounter" in HaMaspik — we will reach it later this year, b'ezrat Hashem.)

Prophets, Not Angels — מלאכי אלהים

מלאכי אלהים = הנביאים. Full stop. Ask 99% of people about Jacob's ladder and they'll describe winged angels going up and down. The Rambam **changes our entire understanding**: it is not angels — it is **prophets**, people striving to ascend and encounter the Divine.

Proof that *malach* can mean a human:

וישלח מלאך ויצאנו ממצרים והנה אנחנו בקדש

(Parashat Chukat) "He sent a *malach* and took us out of Egypt" — clearly **Moshe Rabbeinu**.

ויעל מלאך ה' מן הגלגל אל הבכים

(Shoftim) The *malach* went up from Gilgal to Bochim **and spoke to the people** — this cannot be a winged angel; it must be flesh and blood. The midrashim say it was **Pinchas**.

This makes total sense linguistically: **מלאך comes from הלך**, to go — a *malach* is simply a **messenger**. Angels are called *malachim* because they are God's messengers; a human messenger is equally a *malach*. (The Rambam deliberately did *not* quote וישלח יעקב מלאכים לפניו אל עשו — because there the meaning is arguable, and he didn't want to enter the discussion; he chose unambiguous proofs.)

The Gemara in Moed Katan now makes sense:

אם דומה הרב למלאך ה' צבאות — יבקשו תורה מפיהו, ואם לאו — אל יבקשו תורה מפיהו

(On the verse in Malachi: כי שפתי כהן ישמרו דעת ותורה יבקשו מפיהו כי מלאך ה' צבאות הוא.) Just as a rav must choose his talmid carefully (the Gemara in Makkot — lest he end up in exile with him), a talmid must choose his rav carefully: only seek Torah from a rav who is like a *malach Hashem* — a person of spiritual stature.

And the Rambam's reading is not novel — the Midrash (Bereishit Rabbah) already says on Yaakov's ladder:

ולמדנו לנביאים שנקראים מלאכים... והנה מלאכי אלהים — זה משה ואהרן

The *malachei Elokim* of the ladder are not angels but prophets — Moshe and Aharon (a different interpretation from the Rambam's, but the same fundamental move).

Why Ascent Before Descent — עלים וירדים

כמה מדויקים דבריו: עולים ויורדים — how precise the verse is: ascending **before** descending. Why? Because **after** the ascent and the attainment of a level on the ladder of encountering the Divine, **באה הירידה** — the descent comes — **להנהיג את אנשי הארץ**, *to lead and teach the people of the land*.

Recall Chapter 10 (two weeks ago): *aliyah* and *yeridah* can be physical — but can also mean the **movement of the mind**, ascent and descent of the intellect. That is the meaning here: the prophets ascend in thought to whatever level they attain — and then **bring it back down to the people**. You cannot be a prophet your whole life and simply stay there; you must come down to the people.

Reading the Vision Whole (and a link back to Chapter 14)

והנה סלם מצב ארצה — how beautifully this fits the previous chapter — the bottom of the ladder is in *adamah*, where the people who remain *Adam* stay.

וראשו מגיע השמימה — its top reaches heavenward.

והנה מלאכי אלהים עלים וירדים בו — the noble ones, the prophets, the *ishim* (the *bnei Elohim* of Chapter 14!) ascend to encounter the Divine — and descend to teach.

והנה ה' נצב עליו — and Hashem is **constantly, permanently there on top**.

Standing on the Rock — ונצבת על הצור

ובמשמעות הזאת — with meaning 2 we can also understand the episode of Moshe (touched on last week under *amidah*). Moshe asks:

ויאמר הראני נא את כבדך

(The Rambam will treat these verses fully in later chapters.) And Hashem answers:

ויאמר ה' הנה מקום אתי ונצבת על הצור

Look how everything comes together — the Rambam here relies on **two** other chapters:

הנה מקום אתי — *makom*, as we learned in **Chapter 8**, means **rank, status**. "There is a high rank with Me."

ונצבת על הצור — *tzur*, as the Rambam will explain in **Chapter 16** (next term), means the **Creator — the source and origin of all existence**.

So: you asked to see My glory, you want this *makom*, this rank? **ונצבת על הצור — you shall be *permanently* on the tzur**: constantly, stably contemplating the Source of all existence.

Why must the Rambam read it this way? If *nitzavta* meant literal standing, then standing "with God" on the rock would imply a **spatial context for Hakadosh Baruch Hu** — impossible. Therefore it must mean permanence and stability: there is a *makom*, a status, in which you maintain a **constant perspective on the tzur**.

And the Rambam closes the chapter:

והנה כבר התבאר לך שמשמעות ניצב ועמד אחת היא בענין זה

Nitzav and *amad* are one and the same in this sense — as it says: **הנני עמד לפניך שם על הצור בחרב** — "I stand before you there on the rock at Chorev." *Omed* (Chapter 13, meaning 3) and *nitzav* (Chapter 15, meaning 2) both mean **permanence**: I am permanently with you, just as you are with Me — a constant, mutual relationship. You stand permanently contemplating the tzur; **הנני עמד לפניך** — I am constantly with you upon it.

Chapter 15 — Summary

Nitzav has two meanings: (1) to stand **firmly, erect and tall** (Miriam peering; the kings of Tehillim 2; Datan and Aviram; the *bnei ha-Elohim* in Iyov; hence *matzeivah*); (2) **permanence and stability** (לעולם ה' דברך נצב בשמים — permanent like the heavens). **In relation to Hakadosh Baruch Hu it always means the second**: the eternal, unchanging nature of God, never physical posture. Hence Yaakov's ladder is a vision of **prophets** — not winged angels — ascending to attain knowledge of God and descending to teach the people, while **Hashem remains**

permanently above all of existence, on top of the ladder but not part of it. And hence ונצבת על הצור: be permanently fixed in contemplation of the Source of all existence — with Hashem's reciprocal הנני עמד לפניך שם.

Q&A

Mark: Did Moshe never descend? Or did he have to descend to speak to the people? — The Rabbi: an excellent question, and one he had thought about himself. There seems to be a contradiction: on the one hand ואתה פה עמד עמדי, ונצבת על הצור, הנני עמד לפניך — Moshe is told to be **constantly** with Hashem (which is why Moshe separated from his wife — not something we generally emulate; we believe in being part of the world, but Moshe's utterly unique constant relationship demanded it). On the other hand, Moshe **led the people** — the ladder itself teaches עולים **ויורדים**, descending to teach. The answer (tentatively — perhaps it becomes clearer later in the Moreh): one must distinguish **two elements within Moshe** — an intellectual Moshe in constant thought, permanently על הצור, contemplating the Almighty without interruption, while simultaneously communicating those words to the people. How is such a level possible? "I don't know how" — but that is what one must say to resolve the contradiction.

A participant (end of shiur), supporting this answer: In Shemot 34, after 40 days and nights with Hashem, ויהי ברדת משה — Moshe comes down and **puts the masveh (veil/mask) over his face**. The Rabbi, delighted: this fits beautifully as an answer to Mark's question — Moshe *remains* with Hashem (עמד עמדי), but to connect with the people he must "come down" in some sense, and even then requires the masveh just to speak with them. There is indeed "some kind of coming down" — but the *redet* is not a full departure from the encounter.

Pinchas: Does the concept of the **hitpashtut of Moshe Rabbeinu b'chol dor vador** (an extension/presence of Moshe in every generation — perhaps from the Zohar?) tie in with ונצבת על הצור — a sort of permanent representation "with" Hashem? — The Rabbi: first we must define the concept. If it means there is someone in every generation carrying Moshe's mandate, the Rambam would likely **not** accept it — for the Rambam, **there is nothing like Moshe**. The Rabbi always understood it to mean Moshe's **influence** persists in every generation, not that there is a Moshe-figure in every generation. But *if* one takes the first reading, one could perhaps interpret ונצבת על הצור as "there will be an element of you permanently on the tzur, in every generation." Perhaps. Interesting — but the source and meaning need checking (the Rabbi doubts it is actually the Zohar).

(Jack's observation on the definite article in the Chapter 14 proof-texts is recorded above in Chapter 14.)

Coming Up — Next Term (Elul)

- **Chapter 16 — Tzur (צור):** not reached this evening. In one word for now: *tzur* means **the Source of all existence** — which is what unlocks ויאמר ה' הנה מקום אתי ונצבת על הצור. A whole chapter awaits; it completes the theme.
- **Chapter 17** then begins an entirely **new theme** in the Moreh.
- **Summer chazarah — the Rabbi's personal request:** in many years of giving shiurim he has never asked this before. To take this journey seriously, please review **Chapters 1–15** over the

break — via the note summaries (Baruch Hashem for Dan's summaries!), the transcripts, the recordings, or reading the Moreh itself — so that in Elul we go straight in.

B'Ezrat Hashem

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